

U.S. History Since 1877

HIST 1302 – Section 701

Department of History & Political Science

Summer 2026

Instructor Information

Instructor: Dr. Eloise T. Vanthorpe

Email: etvanthorpe@wcu.edu

Office Location: Huston Hall 207

Office Hours: MWF 12:00pm – 1:30pm or by appointment

Preferred Method of Contact: etvanthorpe@wcu.edu or Campus LMS Inbox

When emailing, please include your course section number or class meeting time. My goal is to respond to all student communications within 24–48 hours on weekdays.

Teaching Assistant(s)

Ravi Subramanian | Discussion Section TA | rsubramanian@wcu.edu

Tamika Jordan | Discussion Section TA | tjordan@wcu.edu

Course Details

Meeting Days/Times/Locations

Start Date	End Date	Location	Meeting Day	Start Time	End Time
05/27/2026	09/15/2026	HUST 0112	TTh	2:00 PM	3:15 PM

Credit Hours: 3.00

Course Description

A survey of United States history from the end of Reconstruction through the present. Topics include industrialization, immigration, the Progressive Era, World Wars I and II, the Cold War, the Civil Rights Movement, and contemporary America. Emphasizes the use of primary sources and historical analysis.

Required Texts and Materials

Textbook: Give Me Liberty! An American History

ISBN: 9780393697827

Authors: Foner, Eric

Publisher: W. W. Norton & Company

Edition: 6th

Additional Required Materials

- Primary Source Reader: American Voices (provided as PDF on LMS)
- Chicago Manual of Style 17th Ed. (online access via library)
- Blue Book exam booklets (available at campus store)

Course Learning Outcomes

Upon successful completion of this course, students will be able to:

1. CLO 1: Identify major events, individuals, and movements in U.S. history from 1877 to the present
2. CLO 2: Analyze primary source documents using historical thinking skills
3. CLO 3: Construct well-supported historical arguments in written form
4. CLO 4: Evaluate the causes and effects of major historical turning points
5. CLO 5: Recognize diverse perspectives including race, class, gender, and region in historical narratives
6. CLO 6: Connect historical developments to contemporary social and political issues

Grading Policies & Grading Scale

Grade Breakdown

Activity	Weight	Details
Participation & Discussion	10%	Weekly discussion posts on LMS + in-class contributions
Reading Quizzes	10%	Unannounced; based on assigned readings; lowest 3 dropped
Primary Source Analysis Paper	10%	2–3 page close reading of a primary document; due Jun 20
Midterm Exam 1	15%	Short answer + essay; Covers Weeks 1–4; June 25, 2026
Comparative Essay	15%	4–5 pages comparing two historical events; due Jul 17
Midterm Exam 2	15%	Short answer + essay; Covers Weeks 5–9; July 24, 2026
Research Paper	15%	6–8 page argumentative paper with primary sources; due Aug 28
Final Exam	10%	Essay-based; September 13, 2026; 2:00 PM – 4:00 PM
Total	100%	

Grading Scale

A	A-	B+	B	B-	C+	C	C-	D+	D	D-	F
100–93	92–90	89–87	86–83	82–80	79–77	76–73	72–70	69–67	66–63	62–60	59–00

NOTE: Final grades are recorded as posted. No grade changes will be made after final grades are submitted.

Late Work Policy

- Late work is penalized 10% per day of delay.
- Assignments more than 5 days late will not be accepted.
- Lab/in-class work cannot be made up without a documented, university-approved excuse.

Important Exam Dates

Assessment	Date / Details
Midterm Exam 1	Short answer + essay; Covers Weeks 1–4; June 25, 2026
Midterm Exam 2	Short answer + essay; Covers Weeks 5–9; July 24, 2026
Final Exam	Essay-based; September 13, 2026; 2:00 PM – 4:00 PM

Course Schedule

Note: This schedule is subject to change. Any modifications will be announced via the LMS and/or email.

Week / Dates	Topic(s)	Assignments / Notes
Week 1 (May 27–29)	Reconstruction & Its Aftermath	Discussion post 1 due Sun
Week 2 (Jun 2–5)	Gilded Age & Industrialization	Reading Quiz possible; Discussion post 2
Week 3 (Jun 9–12)	Immigration & Urban America	Discussion post 3; Primary Source Analysis assigned
Week 4 (Jun 16–19)	Populism & the Progressive Era	Primary Source Analysis due Jun 20
Week 5 (Jun 23–26)	EXAM 1 – Jun 25 American Imperialism & WWI	Discussion post 4
Week 6 (Jun 30–Jul 3)	The 1920s: Culture & Politics	Discussion post 5 (No class Jul 3)
Week 7 (Jul 7–10)	The Great Depression & New Deal	Comparative Essay assigned; Discussion post 6
Week 8 (Jul 14–17)	World War II	Comparative Essay due Jul 17; Discussion post 7
Week 9 (Jul 21–24)	EXAM 2 – Jul 24 The Early Cold War	Discussion post 8
Week 10 (Jul 28–31)	The 1950s & Korean War	Research Paper proposal due Jul 31
Week 11 (Aug 4–7)	Civil Rights Movement	Discussion post 9; Reading Quiz possible

Week / Dates	Topic(s)	Assignments / Notes
Week 12 (Aug 11–14)	Vietnam War & Social Upheaval	Research Paper outline due Aug 14
Week 13 (Aug 18–21)	The Conservative Turn (1970s–1980s)	Discussion post 10
Week 14 (Aug 25–28)	Post-Cold War & Contemporary America	Research Paper due Aug 28
Week 15 (Sep 1–5)	Review & Synthesis	Final prep; no new content
Final Exam	September 13, 2026 2:00 PM – 4:00 PM	Comprehensive Essay Exam

Course Policies

- All written work must follow Chicago citation style; improper citation will result in a grade penalty.
- Late papers lose 1/3 of a letter grade per day; no late work accepted after 5 days.
- Use of Generative AI for any portion of written assignments is strictly prohibited and constitutes academic dishonesty.
- Students are expected to complete all assigned readings prior to class.
- Respectful dialogue is required in all discussions; disruptive behavior will result in removal.
- Participation grade requires consistent, substantive contributions to both online and in-person discussions.

Attendance Policy

Regular attendance is essential to success in this course. Students are expected to attend all scheduled class sessions and arrive on time. Attendance will be recorded each session.

Free Absences: Students are permitted two (2) free lecture absences and one (1) free lab absence per semester without penalty or documentation. Use these wisely.

Religious Observances: Notify the instructor in writing within the first two weeks of the semester. Arrangements for make-up work must be made in advance.

University Events: Provide official documentation from your university sponsor. Contact the instructor well in advance.

Exam Day Absences: Medical absences on exam days require documentation from a physician or the University Health Center and will be handled on a case-by-case basis.

Academic Integrity

Students are expected to maintain the highest standards of academic honesty. All submitted work must represent the student's own effort. Violations of the Academic Integrity Policy, including plagiarism,

cheating, or unauthorized use of AI-generated content, will be referred to the Office of Academic Affairs and may result in a failing grade for the assignment or the course.

Generative AI Policy

The use of generative AI tools (including but not limited to ChatGPT, Google Gemini, Copilot, and DALL-E) is governed by the policy stated in the grading section above. Any violations will be treated as academic dishonesty. Students are encouraged to maintain time-stamped drafts and notes as evidence of independent work.

Disability Accommodations & Title IX

Disability Accommodations

Students who require academic accommodations must register with the Disability Resource Center (DRC) at drc.wcu.edu or by calling 828-227-2716. Once registered, students must submit an accommodation letter to the instructor at least one week before accommodations are needed. Accommodations are not retroactive.

Sexual Harassment & Title IX

All forms of sexual harassment, including sexual assault and dating violence, violate WCU policy and may violate federal law. Students may report concerns to the Title IX Coordinator at titleix@wcu.edu or 828-227-7021. Faculty are mandatory reporters.

Student Support Services

- Academic Success Center – Free tutoring and academic coaching: asc.wcu.edu
- Writing & Learning Commons – Writing support for all disciplines: writingcenter.wcu.edu
- Counseling & Psychological Services (CAPS) – Mental health support: 828-227-7469
- University Health Services – Medical and wellness support: 828-227-7640
- Dean of Students Office – Emergency support and student advocacy: 828-227-7234

Note: This syllabus is subject to change. The instructor reserves the right to modify the course schedule, assignments, and policies. Changes will be announced promptly via the LMS.